



Imagine a tiny creature, dressed in a fiery red armor, no bigger than a grain of rice, meet the fire ant! These fascinating little critters have a reddish-brown color, almost like a tiny spark of fire. They are known for their distinctive mound-shaped nests, which they build using soil. And they've got a sting that's as fiery as their color, which is how they got their name.

Now that we've seen their fiery exterior, let's peek into their homes. Fire ants live all over the world, but mostly in warm climates like the southern parts of the United States. They build large colonies in soil, with mounds that can be up to 18 inches high. Inside these mounds, they make a network of tunnels and chambers where they live and raise their young.

From their fiery houses, these little warriors venture out in search of food. They are omnivores, meaning they eat both plants and other small creatures. Their diet includes seeds, fruits, insects, and even small animals. In fact, they are known to attack in groups to take down larger prey.



Fire ants are not just interesting, they're also important players in the ecosystem. They help control pests by eating other insects and small animals. However, they can also be a nuisance to humans, as their stings are painful and can cause allergic reactions. So next time you see a mound in the ground, remember the fiery little warriors beneath, and keep a respectful distance.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What choice is a color that fire ants may be?
A. yellow B. blue C. brown D. green
- 2) How do fire ants help control pests?
A. by scaring away pests B. by building walls to keep pests out
C. by releasing a natural pesticide D. by eating other insects and small animals
- 3) How do fire ants defend themselves?
A. with their sting B. by hiding in their nest
C. by making loud noises D. by flying away
- 4) What do fire ants eat?
A. both plants and other small creatures B. only other small creatures
C. they do not eat D. only plants
- 5) Do fire ant stings cause allergic reactions?
A. Only in animals B. Yes C. Only in some people D. No
- 6) What do fire ants use to build their nests?
A. twigs B. leaves C. rocks D. soil
- 7) Where do fire ants live mostly?
A. warm climates like the southern parts of the United States B. cold climates like the North Pole
C. hot environments like deserts D. wet environments like marshes and swamps
- 8) How big can a fire ant mound be?
A. up to 10 feet B. up to 18 inches
C. up to 3 inches D. up to 1 mile
- 9) What is the size of a fire ant?
A. About the size of a cell phone B. About the size of a grain of rice
C. Microscopic D. About the size of a golf ball
- 10) Which choice best describes fire ants diets?
A. plants only B. animals only
C. plants and animals D. fire ants do not eat

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "Plants and small creatures, we consume them all, we are true omnivores."
- 12) "Fear our strength! Even large prey is vulnerable when we attack in groups."
- 13) "Some people think our homes look like tiny volcanoes. They are mounds built from soil."
- 14) "We pose no nuisance to humans."

- 15) "Our homes beneath the mounds are interconnected by tunnels and chambers where we raise our young."
- 16) "I just adore cold climates, the chillier the better."
- 17) "I am a peaceful ant and not a warrior."
- 18) "Our stings can be quite a bother to humans, they can cause painful allergic reactions."
- 19) "By dining on other insects and small animals, we assist in pest control."
- 20) "We're pretty small. Usually around the size of a rice grain."
- 21) "I couldn't survive in warm climates."
- 22) "The mounds we build can be up to 18 inches high. That's probably as tall as your desk."
- 23) "I am a vegetarian."
- 24) "We fire ants live all over the world, but we prefer warm places like the southern parts of the United States."
- 25) "Our colonies are always small less than an inch tall."
- 26) "Sting? No way, I'm a peaceful creature."
- 27) "Beware of my sting, it burns like fire, hence my name - fire ant."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 28) Fire ants help to control pests by eating other insects and small animals.
- 29) Fire ants stings, which are very painful, make them very scary to be around.
- 30) Fire ants are omnivores, they eat both plants and other creatures.
- 31) The mounds that fire ants build are fascinating to see.
- 32) Fire ants build their homes in soil, forming mounds.
- 33) Fire ants are more fun to learn about than regular ants.
- 34) A fire ant sting can cause painful allergic reactions in humans.
- 35) Fire ant colonies can be found in warm climates, like southern parts of the United States.
- 36) The reddish-brown color of fire ants is quite beautiful.
- 37) Fire ants are extraordinary because they can conquer larger prey.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 38) Fire ants may eat fruits and seeds.
- 39) Unlike other ants, fire ants build their homes in the trees.
- 40) Fire ants build their nests using soil.
- 41) Fire ants are typically dark brown, almost black.
- 42) Fire ants build mounds that can reach up to 18 inches in height.
- 43) Fire ant colonies are usually found in cold areas.
- 44) Fire ants do not have stingers and defend by biting.
- 45) Fire ants are predators and only eat other insects.
- 46) Fire ants are known to attack in large groups.
- 47) Fire ants got their name because of their painful sting.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

- 48)** There's a special fly that helps control fire ant populations by laying eggs inside them.
- A. There are B. There is
C. They are D. There was



- 67) Fire ants are known to prey on small animals and can even damage crops. Based on this statement, what conclusion can be drawn about fire ants?
- A. Fire ants solely feed on crops.
 - B. Fire ants do not interact with any other organisms.
 - C. Fire ants are typically harmless to crops and small animals.
 - D. Fire ants can pose a serious threat to biodiversity and farming.
- 68) When a fire ant mound is disturbed, the ants get aggressive and attack to defend their colony. Based on this statement, what conclusion can be drawn about fire ants?
- A. Fire ants have venomous stingers, but they prefer running away to using them.
 - B. Fire ants are naturally friendly and calm insects.
 - C. Fire ants can't defend their colony.
 - D. Fire ants are fiercely protective of their colony.
- 69) Fire ants have a painful sting and are more aggressive than other ant species. Based on this statement, what conclusion can we draw about the relationship between fire ants and humans?
- A. Fire ants can be harmful to humans.
 - B. Fire ants make great pets for humans.
 - C. Fire ants are defenseless against humans.
 - D. Fire ants are friendly to humans.



Fire Ants

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 68. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | 69. _____ |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	C	26.	Not	51.	A
2.	D	27.	Would	52.	C
3.	A	28.	fact	53.	exclamatory
4.	A	29.	opinion	54.	imperative
5.	B	30.	fact	55.	interrogative
6.	D	31.	opinion	56.	exclamatory
7.	A	32.	fact	57.	declarative
8.	B	33.	opinion	58.	interrogative
9.	B	34.	fact	59.	declarative
10.	C	35.	fact	60.	interrogative
11.	Would	36.	opinion	61.	declarative
12.	Would	37.	opinion	62.	imperative
13.	Would	38.	true	63.	exclamatory
14.	Not	39.	false	64.	imperative
15.	Would	40.	true	65.	B
16.	Not	41.	false	66.	A
17.	Not	42.	true	67.	D
18.	Would	43.	false	68.	D
19.	Would	44.	false	69.	A
20.	Would	45.	false		
21.	Not	46.	true		
22.	Would	47.	true		
23.	Not	48.	B		
24.	Would	49.	A		
25.	Not	50.	D		